



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:	Lifting Safely - Carrying				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Each day in some form or fashion you do lifting at work and at home.

Lifting safely is one the most important things you can do to protect your back throughout your lifetime.

Lift Properly, So Your Legs Do the Work—Not Your Back

- Stand close to the load, with feet shoulder width apart and firmly on the floor.
- Bend at the hips and knees and squat close to the load; keep your back straight.
- Grip the load firmly with both hands, not just your fingers.
- Bring the load close to your body, keeping your weight centred over your feet.
- Stand slowly with your back straight and let your legs push you up.

Avoid Back Strain While Carrying

- Carry the load waist high.
- Be sure you have a good grip and can see where you are going.
- Walk slowly, taking small steps.
- Stop along the way to rest if you need it.
- Move your feet to turn direction.
- Do not twist! That is a major cause of injury.

Remember: if a load is too heavy to lift on your own ask someone to help you or if possible split the load to a smaller more manageable size and take more trips.

Discussion Points

Has anyone had a back injury? How could this have been prevented?

Are there common objects which you find yourself lifting frequently?

Do you have specific procedures for lifting some objects?

Do you have access to material handling equipment? If no, can you obtain them?